FROM EDEN TO THE NEW EARTH

The Way Back Home

The true story of the biggest rescue ever

Story by Johnny Wall

A GIFT FOR YOU

Read it, then pass it on, so someone else can find the way home too.

Hey, you! Ready for a journey?

This road starts in a perfect garden and ends in a brand-new world. In between is the biggest rescue story ever told.

It is not made up. It is all from the Bible, God's true book. And it is about **you**.

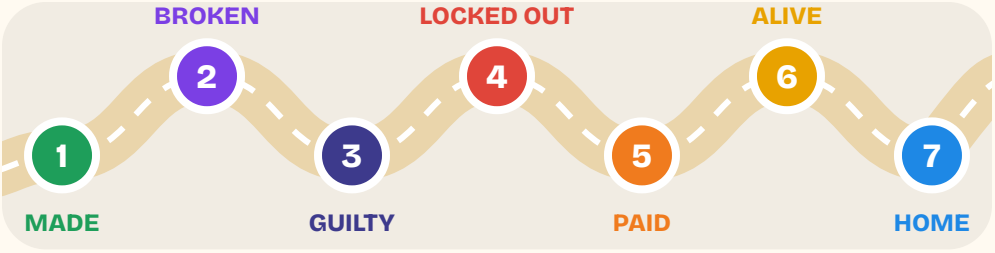
How to use this book

Follow the road. There are 7 stops. The map is on the next pages.

Look up the verses. Every page tells you where to find them in the Bible.

Spot the lamb. When you see this sign, a lamb is part of the story. Watch where it leads!

Scan me! Hear the story read aloud and watch it move, in many languages.



7 stops.
1 road home.

Here is the whole Bible story in 7 words. By the end, you'll be able to tell it on your fingers!

1 **Made** — God made everything, and it was very good. — 6

2 **Broken** — Adam and Eve disobeyed, and sin broke everything. — 11

3 **Guilty** — We have all sinned. Me too. — 17

4 **Locked out** — Sin locks us out of God's home. — 24

5 **Paid** — Jesus died in my place. — 29

6 **Alive** — Jesus rose again! Turn and trust Him. — 33

7 **Home** — Jesus welcomes His children home. — 37

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FROM EDEN TO THE NEW EARTH

The road map

3

GUILTY

We have all sinned. Me too.

PAGE 17

2

BROKEN

Adam and Eve disobeyed, and sin broke everything.

PAGE 11

1

MADE

God made everything, and it was very good.

PAGE 6

4

LOCKED OUT

Sin locks us out of God's home.

PAGE 24

5

PAID

Jesus died in my place.

PAGE 29

6

ALIVE

Jesus rose again! Turn and trust Him.

PAGE 33

7

HOME

Jesus welcomes His children home.

PAGE 37

STOP 1

MADE

God made everything. And it was very good.

> God saw all that he had made, and it was very good indeed.
>
> GENESIS 1:31

1 MADE

In the beginning...

Before there was anything, there was God. No sky, no ground, no time. Just God. Then God spoke, and everything began!

DAY 1
Light

DAY 2
Sky and water

DAY 3
Land, seas and plants

DAY 4
Sun, moon and stars

DAY 5
Fish and birds

DAY 6
Animals and people

DAY 7
God rested

> **In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth.**
>
> GENESIS 1:1

DID YOU KNOW?

God didn't need any bricks or paint. He made the whole universe out of nothing, just by speaking! Light, planets, puppies, pineapples... all of it.

Hebrews 11:3

1 MADE

Made like God

On day six, God made the first man, Adam, from the dust of the ground. He breathed life into him. Then He made the first woman, Eve. They were made **in God's image**: made to think, to love, to create, and most of all to know God.

That's true of you too. You are not an accident. God made you on purpose.

> **So God created man in his own image; he created him in the image of God; he created them male and female.**
>
> GENESIS 1:27

1 MADE

A garden home called Eden

God planted a garden in a place called Eden and gave it to Adam and Eve as their home. Rivers ran through it. Every kind of tree grew there, full of fruit. Adam even got to name all the animals!

Best of all, **God was with them.** They loved being with Him, and He loved them. There was no fear, no shame, no sickness and no death. Everything was perfect.

TWO SPECIAL TREES

In the middle of the garden stood **the tree of life** and **the tree of the knowledge of good and evil**. Remember the tree of life. You'll see it again at the very end of the road!

Genesis 2:7–25

1 MADE

One simple rule

God gave Adam and Eve every tree in the garden to enjoy, except one: the tree of the knowledge of good and evil. Adam pointed to the tree so Eve would remember.

Was God being mean? No way! He gave them a whole garden full of **yes** and only one **no**. That one rule was a chance to trust Him: “God knows best.”

Genesis 2:16–17

BROKEN

One choice broke everything.

> ...when sin is fully grown, it gives birth to death.
>
> JAMES 1:15

2 BROKEN

The sneaky serpent

One day, a serpent slid up beside Eve. This was no ordinary snake. It was Satan, God’s enemy, the one the Bible calls the father of all lies.

“Did God really say that?” he hissed. “You won’t die! That fruit will make you like God!” The serpent wanted Eve to stop trusting God.

SPOT THE LIE

God said:
“If you eat it, you will die.”

The serpent said:
“You won’t die!”

Who was telling the truth? **God never lies.** Not ever.

Genesis 3:1–5 · John 8:44 · Revelation 12:9 · Titus 1:2

2 BROKEN

Just one bite

Eve looked at the fruit. It looked so good. She wanted it. So she reached out and took a bite.

Then she gave some to Adam, who was right there with her. And he ate it too.

Genesis 3:6

Uh-oh.

For the very first time, people had disobeyed God. The Bible calls this **sin**.

Sin is when we go our own way instead of God's way, in what we think, say or do.

And the serpent grinned. The trick had worked.

WHAT HAPPENED NEXT?

Adam and Eve **hid** from God among the trees. When God asked what they had done, Adam blamed Eve, and Eve blamed the serpent. Sound familiar?

Genesis 3:6–13

2 BROKEN

Sin changed everything

Now Adam and Eve felt afraid and ashamed. Sin had brought pain, sadness and death into God's perfect world.

But God still came looking for them. "Where are you?" He called. And God made them clothes from animal skins. To make them, **innocent animals had to die**. That's how serious sin is.

Spot the lamb! This was the first time anything died, and it died to cover Adam and Eve's shame. Keep watching for this on the road.

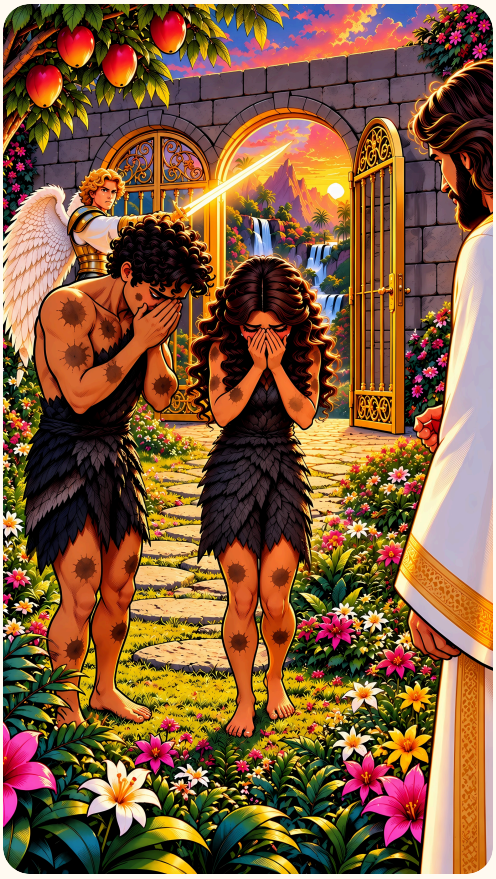
Genesis 3:8–21

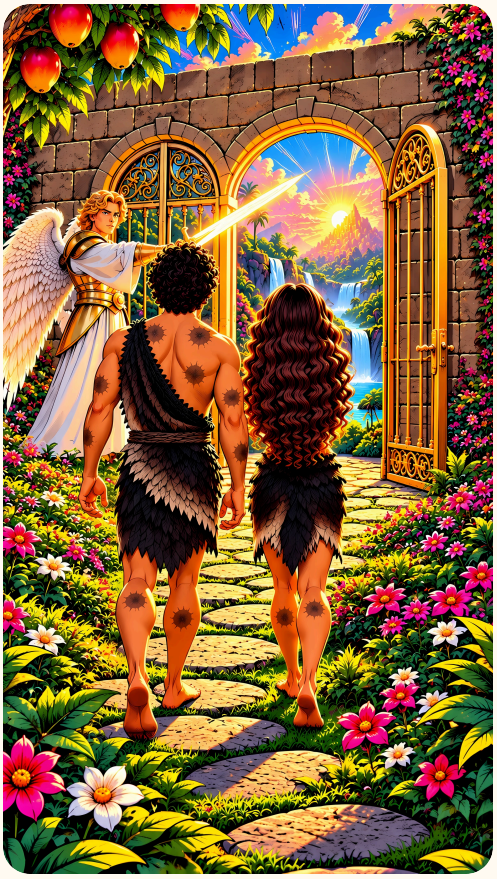
★ GOD MADE A PROMISE

One day, a child of Eve will come. The serpent will strike His heel, but He will crush the serpent's head.

Someone was coming to beat the enemy and open the way back home. The whole road leads to Him!

Genesis 3:15





Locked out of the garden

Then God sent Adam and Eve out of Eden. A mighty angel with a flaming sword guarded the way back to the tree of life. They could not go home.

Genesis 3:22–24

GUILTY

Everybody sins. Me too.

> For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God.
>
> ROMANS 3:23

3 GUILTY

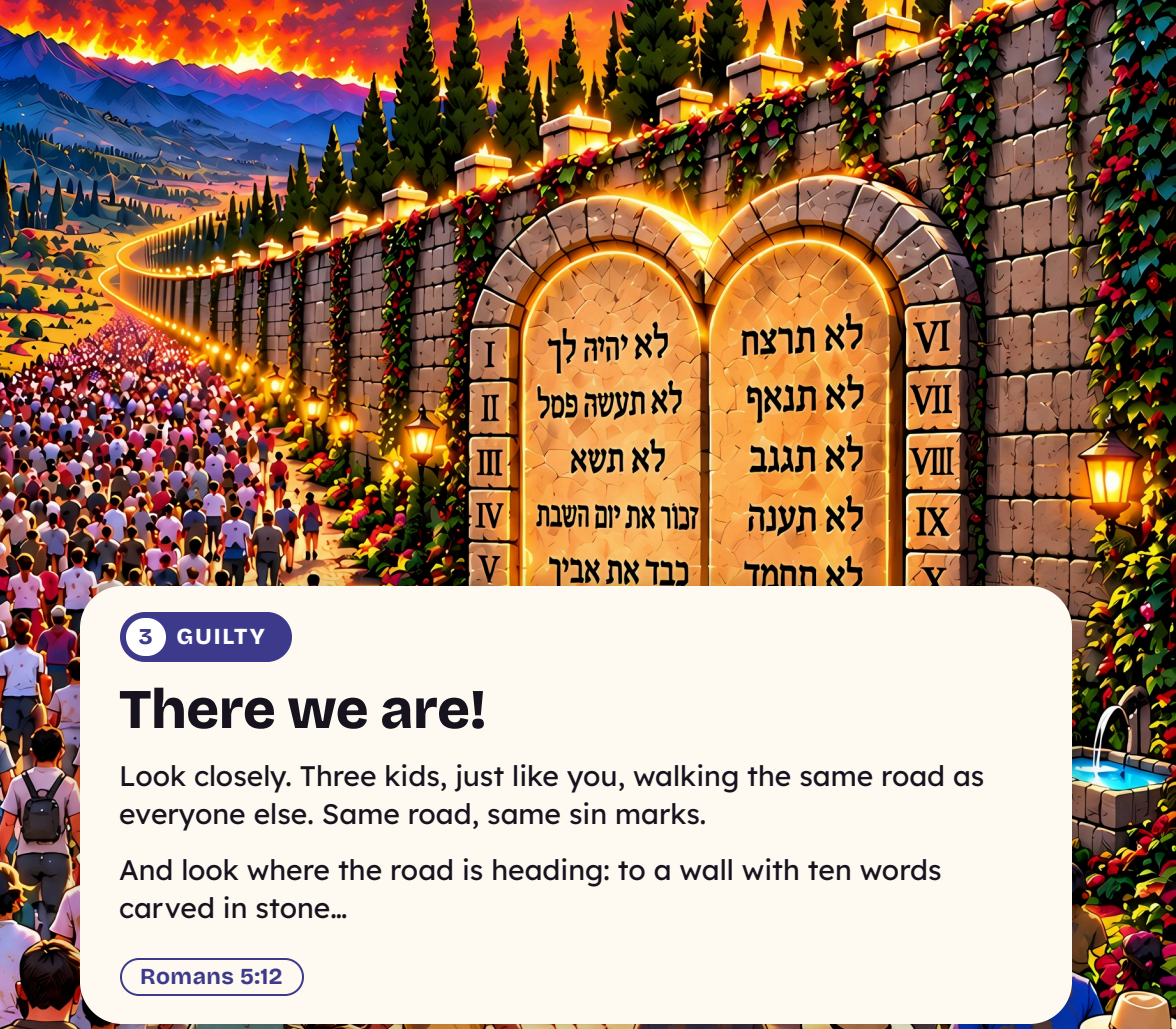
All these people!

Adam and Eve had children, and their children had children, all the way down to you and me.

But sin came along too. Their son Cain got so angry with his brother Abel that he killed him. Sin spread from one person to the next, until it reached every single one of us.

Look at all these people! Every one of them has sin marks, just like Adam and Eve. And our sin keeps us far from God.

Genesis 4:1–8 · Romans 5:12 · Isaiah 59:2



3 GUILTY

There we are!

Look closely. Three kids, just like you, walking the same road as everyone else. Same road, same sin marks.

And look where the road is heading: to a wall with ten words carved in stone…

Romans 5:12

The long road

Thousands of years went by. People kept sinning. But God never forgot His promise. Watch it grow along the road…

Noah

The whole world filled up with evil. God saved Noah's family and the animals in a huge boat. Then He put a rainbow in the sky as a promise.

Genesis 6–9

Abraham

God promised Abraham a family as many as the stars, and that through it all nations would be blessed. On a mountain, God gave a ram to die in Isaac's place. Abraham said God would provide the lamb.

Genesis 12:3; 15:5; 22

Moses

In Egypt, God's people put a lamb's blood on their doors, and death passed over them. Then God gave the Ten Commandments.

Exodus 12; 20

King David

God promised David that a King from his family would rule forever.

2 Samuel 7:12–16

The prophets

Isaiah said Someone would be led like a lamb and wounded for our sins. Micah said He would be born in Bethlehem. That was 700 years before it happened!

Isaiah 53; Micah 5:2

Bethlehem

Then one night, a baby was born. The promise was coming true... Find out who at Stop 5!

Luke 2:1–20

Did you spot the lambs? Eden, Abraham's mountain, the Passover doors, Isaiah's scroll... They all point to Someone. Keep reading!

3 GUILTY

Ten good rules

God gave His people ten good rules, called the **Ten Commandments**. They show us what God is like, and how He made us to live. Has anyone ever kept all ten? Only one Person ever has. You'll meet Him at Stop 5!

1. Love God more than anything
2. Don't make anything else your god
3. Use God's name with respect
4. Keep a day to rest and worship God
5. Honour your father and mother
6. Don't murder (even hate in your heart counts!)
7. Keep your promises in marriage
8. Don't steal
9. Don't lie
10. Don't be jealous of what others have

Exodus 20:1–17 · Matthew 5:21–22, 27–28

3 GUILTY

Crack!

Have you ever told a lie? Even once? Have you ever taken something that wasn't yours? If so, that makes you a liar and a thief. That doesn't feel very good, does it?

And that's only two of the ten! Like Adam and Eve, we have all broken God's law, and our sin leaves marks we can't hide.

> **For whoever keeps the entire law, and yet stumbles at one point, is guilty of breaking it all.**
>
> JAMES 2:10

LOCKED OUT

Sin locks us out of God's home.

> **For the wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord.**
>
> ROMANS 6:23

4 LOCKED OUT

The mirror

God’s law is like a mirror. A mirror can show you the dirt on your face, but it can’t wash it off. God’s law shows us our sin, but it can’t take it away.

We were made for God’s home. But sin locks us out, just like Adam and Eve were locked out of the garden.

Romans 3:20 · James 1:23–24

4 LOCKED OUT

Very bad news

God is good and fair. Think about it: if a judge let every robber go free, would he be a good judge? No! God can't just pretend our sin never happened.

The Bible says that if we die with our sin, we will be punished in a place called **hell**, far away from God forever.

That is very bad news.

BUT WAIT...

Did you notice the end of the verse at the start of this stop? *"...but the gift of God is eternal life."* Keep going. The road doesn't end here!

Habakkuk 1:13 · Romans 6:23 · Hebrews 9:27

4 LOCKED OUT

Can we wash it off?

So how can we get rid of our sin? We might try to scrub it off:

1. Being extra good ×
2. Just saying sorry ×
3. Going to church ×

Those are all good things! But no matter how hard we scrub, the marks won't come off.

Isaiah 64:6 · Jeremiah 2:22

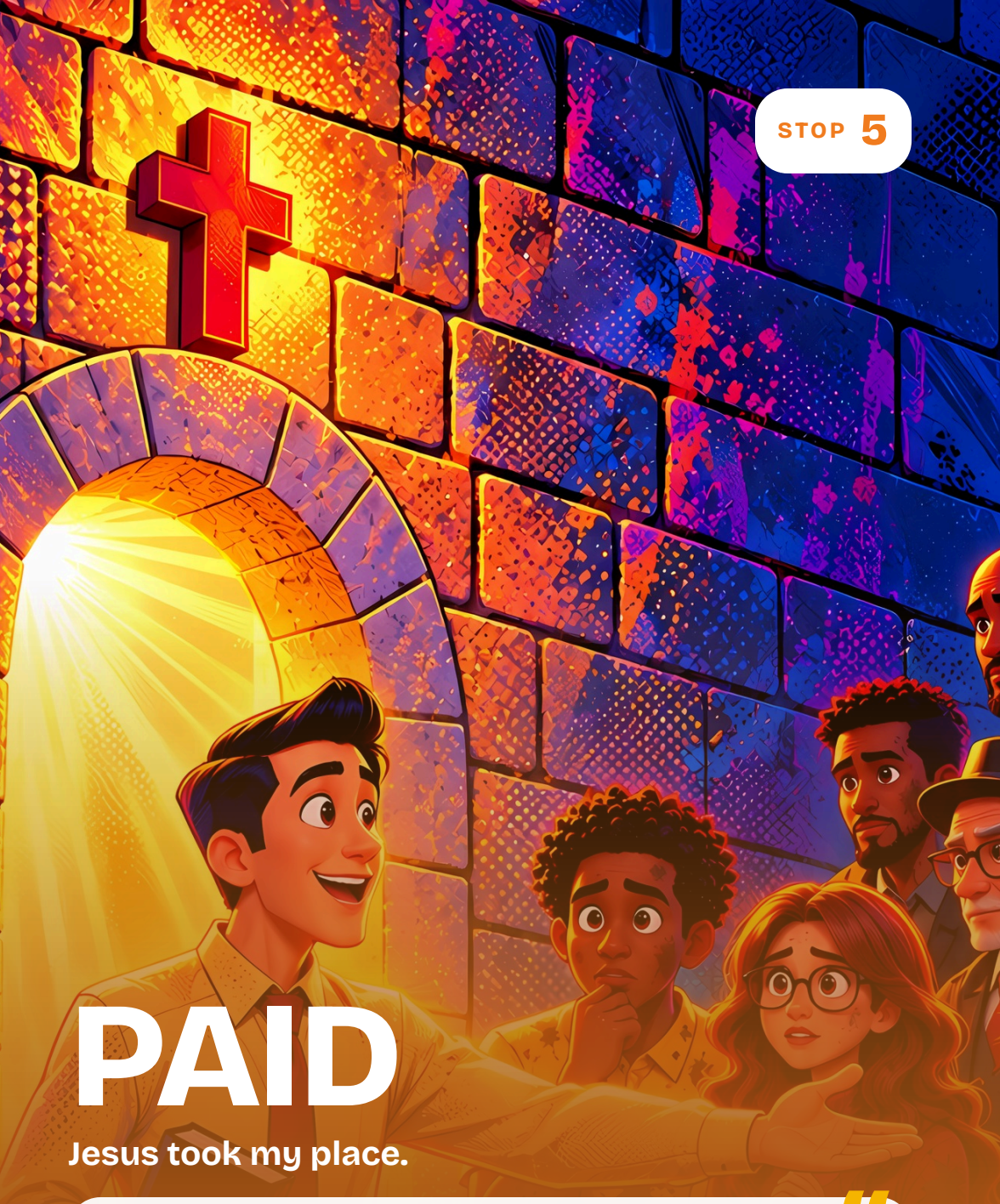
Being good tomorrow can't erase the wrong things we did today.

Remember the animals that died to cover Adam and Eve? And the lambs on the long road? **Someone has to take our place too.**

> **For you are saved by grace through faith, and this is not from yourselves; it is God's gift.**
>
> EPHESIANS 2:8

But who?

Hebrews 9:22 · Ephesians 2:8–9

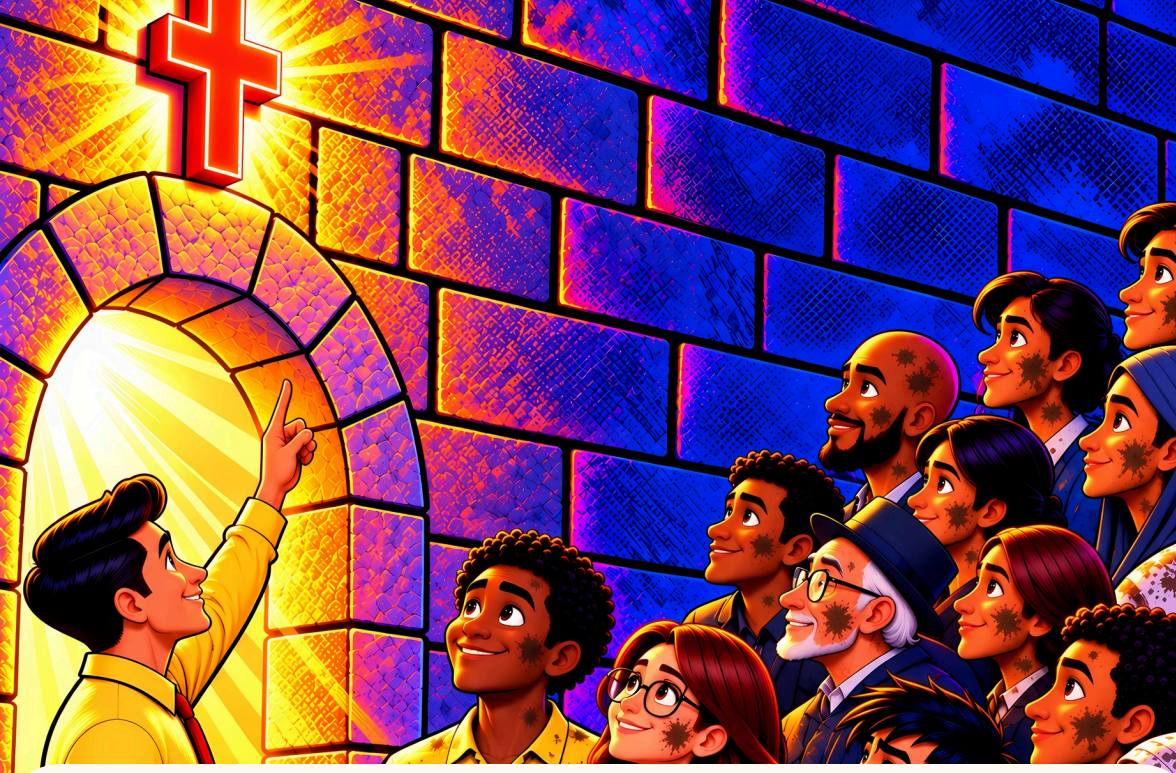


STOP 5

PAID

Jesus took my place.

> **For God loved the world in this way: He gave his one and only Son, so that everyone who believes in him will not perish but have eternal life.**
>
> JOHN 3:16



5 PAID

The good news!

That Someone is **Jesus**, God's own Son. He was there in the garden with Adam and Eve, and He is the One God promised.

God loved the world so much that He sent Jesus to bring us home. Jesus was born as a baby in Bethlehem, just as the prophets said. He grew up and never sinned, not even once. He healed the sick, loved the lonely and taught about God.

When John the Baptist saw Jesus, he shouted, "Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!"

Jesus said He is the door: whoever comes in through Him will be saved.

John 1:1–3, 29 · Luke 2:1–11 · John 10:9 · John 14:6

5 PAID

In our place

Jesus never sinned. But He died on a cross in our place, like the animals that died for Adam and Eve, like the lamb on the long road.

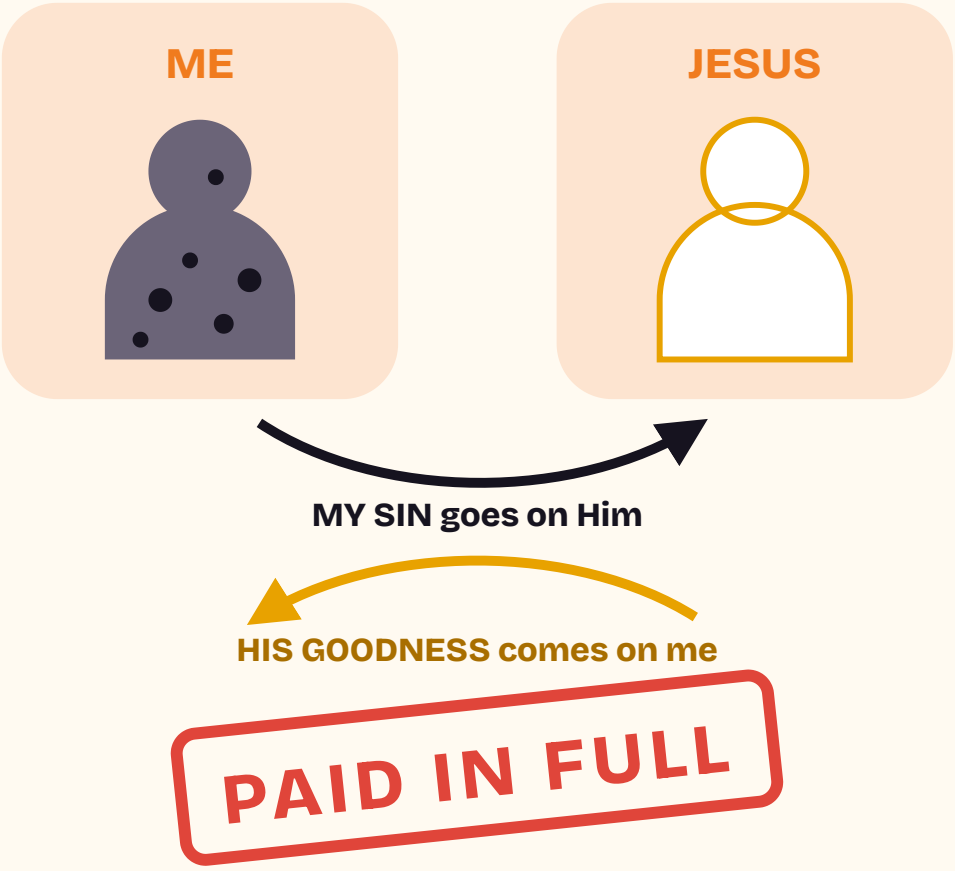
All our sin was put on Him, and He took the punishment we deserved. Before He died, He cried out, **“It is finished!”** Jesus did this because He loves us.

Isaiah 53:5–6 · 1 Peter 2:24 · John 19:30

5 PAID

The great swap

On the cross, Jesus made the best trade in history:



> He made the one who did not know sin to be sin for us, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God.
>
> 2 CORINTHIANS 5:21

ALIVE

Jesus beat sin and death!

> He is not here, but he has risen!
>
> LUKE 24:6

6 ALIVE

Everyone has a choice

Jesus loves you, and He lets you choose. Some people say, “No thanks,” and walk away.

Others tell God, “I’m sorry for my sin. I believe Jesus died in my place. Please forgive me and save me!” That means **turning away from sin** and **trusting Jesus**.

> **If you confess with your mouth, ‘Jesus is Lord,’ and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved.**
>
> ROMANS 10:9

Mark 1:15 · John 3:18 · Romans 10:13

White as snow

When we turn to Jesus, God takes our sin away and covers us with Jesus' goodness, like a brand-new set of clean white clothes.

The marks we could never scrub off? **Gone.** God says that even if our sins are as red as scarlet, He will make them as white as snow.

Isaiah 1:18 · Isaiah 61:10 · 1 John 1:9

6 ALIVE

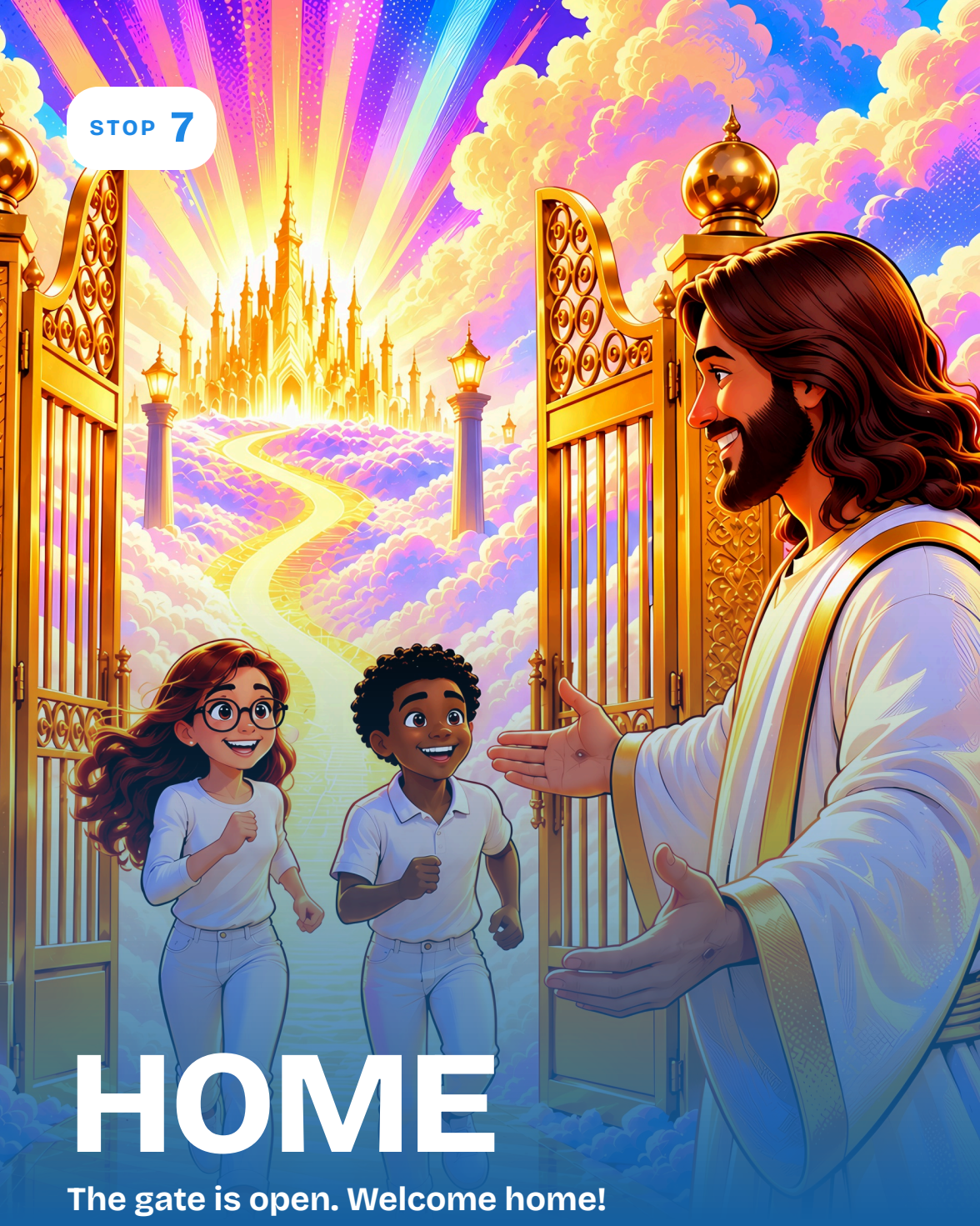
The empty tomb

After Jesus died, His friends laid His body in a tomb and rolled a huge stone across the entrance. Soldiers guarded it.

But three days later, some women came to the tomb early in the morning. The stone was rolled away! An angel said, “He is not here, but he has risen!”

Jesus was alive again! His friends saw Him, ate with Him and touched Him. More than 500 people saw Him at once. He had beaten sin and death!

Matthew 27:57–28:10 · Luke 24:1–8 · 1 Corinthians 15:3–6



HOME

The gate is open. Welcome home!

> **We love because he first loved us.**
>
> 1 JOHN 4:19

7 HOME

Arms open wide

After Jesus rose, He went back to heaven. He promised to get a place ready for us, and to come back for us.

One day, everyone who trusts Jesus will run through heaven's open gates. And Jesus will be right there, with His arms open wide.

The same Jesus who sent Adam and Eve out of the garden will welcome His children home. You can still see the scars in His hands: **the scars of His love.**

John 14:2–3 · Acts 1:9–11 · John 20:27

7 HOME

Everything new!

And guess what? God will make everything new: a new heaven and a new earth, even better than Eden! And God Himself will live with His people.

> **Look, I am making everything new.**
>
> REVELATION 21:5

7 HOME

What will it be like?

> **He will wipe away every tear from their eyes. Death will be no more; grief, crying, and pain will be no more, because the previous things have passed away.**
>
> REVELATION 21:4

- ✓ No more tears, sickness or death
- ✓ No more sin, and no more night
- ✓ God lives right there with His people
- ✓ And the **tree of life** is back!

THE ROAD COMES FULL CIRCLE

The road began at a tree in a garden, where people were locked out. It ends at the tree of life, with the gates wide open forever.

Until that day, Jesus asks you to tell others the good news, so they can find the way back home too.

Revelation 21:1–5 · Revelation 22:1–5 · Matthew 28:19–20

You made it!

Now tell the whole story in 7 words. Count them on your fingers!

1. **Made**
   God made everything, and it was very good.
2. **Broken**
   Adam and Eve disobeyed, and sin broke everything.
3. **Guilty**
   We have all sinned. Me too.
4. **Locked out**
   Sin locks us out of God's home.
5. **Paid**
   Jesus died in my place.
6. **Alive**
   Jesus rose again! Turn and trust Him.
7. **Home**
   Jesus welcomes His children home.

Would you like to follow Jesus?

Here is what it means: A, B, C.

A **Admit** to God that you have sinned, and say you are sorry.

B **Believe** that Jesus is God's Son, that He died for you, and that He rose again.

C **Choose** to trust Jesus and follow Him every day.

YOU CAN PRAY LIKE THIS

"Dear God, I know I have sinned, and I am sorry. Thank You for sending Jesus to die for me and rise again. Please forgive me and make me clean. I want to follow Jesus. In Jesus' name, amen."

Talk with a parent, pastor, or grown-up you trust about what you prayed.

Romans 10:9–10

Your new road

Following Jesus is like walking a road with your best Friend. Here's how to keep walking:

1. **Talk to God** every day. He loves to hear from you.

2. **Read the Bible.** Start with the book of Mark or John.

3. **Find a church** where people love Jesus.

4. **Tell a friend** the way back home.

Did you pray to follow Jesus?

Tell someone today: a parent, a pastor or a Christian friend. Jesus said there is joy in heaven over every person who turns back to God!

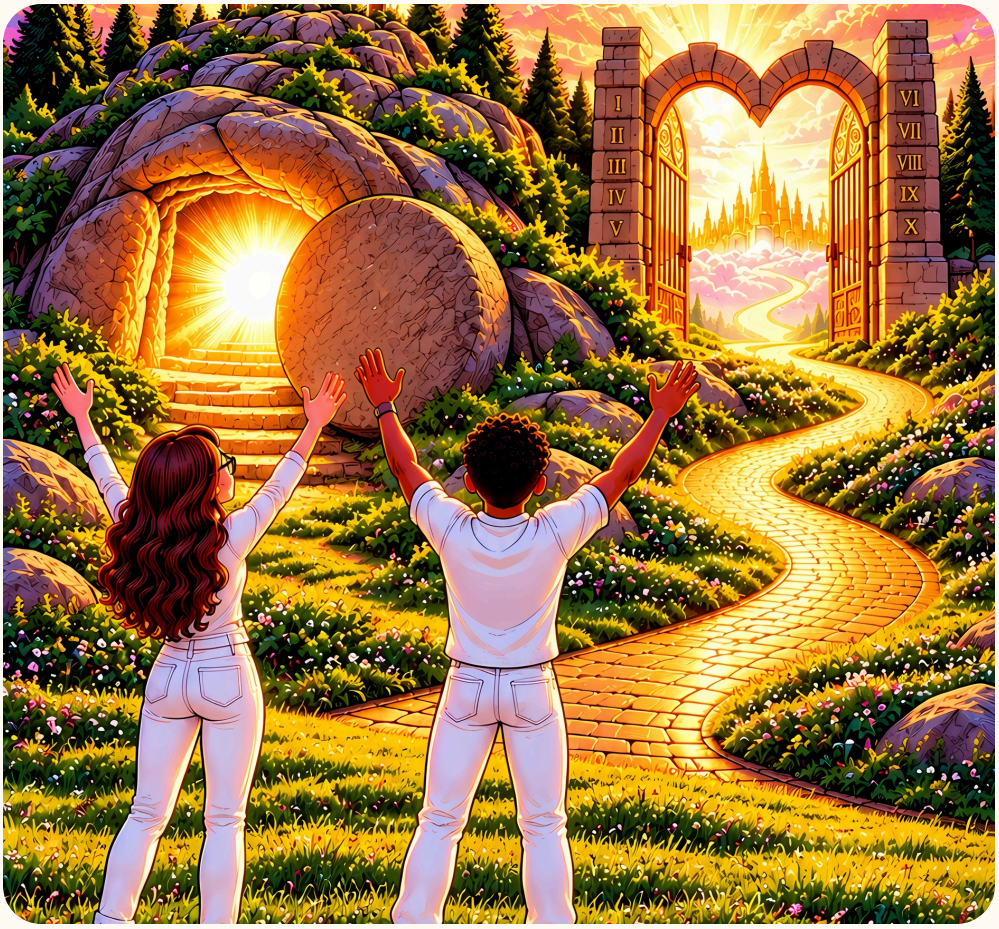
Want to hear it again? Scan to listen to the whole story, read aloud with music and moving pictures. Share it with a friend!

Psalm 119:105 · Luke 15:10 · Hebrews 10:24–25 · Matthew 28:19–20

Pass it on!

The people who know Jesus love to tell others, “Come and see! There is a way back to God!” Here are three easy ways to share the way back home:

1. **Share this book.** Read it with a friend, or give it to someone who needs it.
2. **Show them the code.** Anyone can scan it to hear the story, in many languages.
3. **Tell your favourite stop.** Which of the 7 stops do you like best? Tell someone why.



John 1:46 · John 4:28–30 · Matthew 28:19–20

Hide it in your heart

One verse for each stop. Learn one a week!

1. God saw all that he had made, and it was very good indeed.
   MADE · GENESIS 1:31

2. ...when sin is fully grown, it gives birth to death.
   BROKEN · JAMES 1:15

3. For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God.
   GUILTY · ROMANS 3:23

4. For the wages of sin is death, but the gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord.
   LOCKED OUT · ROMANS 6:23

5. He made the one who did not know sin to be sin for us, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God.
   PAID · 2 CORINTHIANS 5:21

6. He is not here, but he has risen!
   ALIVE · LUKE 24:6

7. Look, I am making everything new.
   HOME · REVELATION 21:5

For grown-ups

Try these questions after reading together.

1. What was the one rule God gave Adam and Eve? Why do you think He gave it?
2. Why couldn't the children scrub their marks away?
3. Where did you spot the lamb on the road? Who is the Lamb of God?
4. What did Jesus do so we could come back to God?
5. How do we know Jesus is alive?
6. What does it mean to trust Jesus? Is that something you want to do?
7. Who is someone you could tell the good news to this week?

Read the whole account

1 Made: Genesis 1–2

2 Broken: Genesis 3; John 8:44; Revelation 12:9; Titus 1:2

3 Guilty: Genesis 4–9, 12, 22; Exodus 12, 20; 2 Samuel 7; Isaiah 53; Micah 5:2; Romans 3:9–23; James 2:10

4 Locked out: Romans 3:20; 6:23; James 1:23–24; Habakkuk 1:13; Hebrews 9:22, 27; Isaiah 64:6; Jeremiah 2:22; Ephesians 2:8–9

5 Paid: Luke 2; John 1:1–3, 29; 3:16; 10:9; 14:6; 19; Isaiah 53:5–6; 2 Corinthians 5:21; 1 Peter 2:24

6 Alive: Mark 1:15; Romans 10:9–13; Isaiah 1:18; 61:10; Luke 24; 1 Corinthians 15:3–6; 1 John 1:9

7 Home: John 14:2–3; 20:27; Acts 1:9–11; Revelation 21–22; Matthew 28:19–20

Hear it. Watch it.

Scan to listen to the story read aloud, with music and moving pictures, in many languages. Free, on any phone.

thewaybackhome.net

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Story by Johnny Wall
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